

Student: Gourik Narendra Patil

Email: aartigaurik251@gmail.com

Discord: GNP_29 🕶️

LaunchRoom - CareerForge Day 6

G/Challenge/day%206/starter-code/index.html

CAREERFORGE DAY 6

LaunchRoom

A constrained incident command window for a live FlashCart product drop. Once you enter, the timer does not pause.

CORE LESSON
Engineering is decision-making under pressure.

Scenario

FlashCart is running a major limited product drop. Checkout traffic spikes, duplicate payments appear, webhooks lag, inventory mismatches surface, refunds rise, and stakeholders disagree.

You are the Incident Command Owner. Your job is not to fix everything. Your job is to protect what matters first and own the tradeoffs.

Before You Enter

Full name
Gourik Narendra Patil

Email
aartigaurik251@gmail.com

Discord username
GNP_29 🕶️

☒ I understand this session can only be attempted once from this device.

ENTER LAUNCH ROOM

Rules

- No pause button. The countdown continues while decisions are pending.
- Some prompts auto-resolve if you do not decide in time.
- You only see what has happened so far.
- Your reasoning, decision latency, and accepted tradeoffs are recorded.

Decision Doctrine

- Protect customer-money trust before cosmetic visibility.
- Contain blast radius when root cause is incomplete.
- Communicate uncertainty before silence becomes damage.
- Defer work deliberately. Do not pretend everything can be solved.

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FLASHCART DROP CRISIS

WINDOW REMAINING
21:56

CURRENT PHASE
Phase 1: First Signals

Level 1: Abnormal trafficDecisions 6/9Timestamps 0Arg 0xEND SESSION

Startup War Room

Conflicting stakeholder pressure arrives in real time.

1 messages

PrisBot Monitoring
Checkout traffic is 4x normal. Drop traffic is accelerating.

Live Launch Metrics

1:06

Active users 1,355	Success rate 96%	Failed payments 13
Duplicate charges 0	Webhook lag 21s	Inventory mismatch 0
Refund requests 0	Support tickets 19	Drop rate 1.3%

Decision Console

Awaiting prompts

No active decision yet. Watch the room and be ready.

DECISION TIMELINE

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FLAMECAST DRDP 18:00

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING 18:45

CURRENT PHASE Phase 2: Customer Money Impact

Level 0: Customer complaints

Decisions: 0/9

Timestamps: 0

Ang: 0s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

Confirming customer purchase arrives in real time.

3 messages

Patrick Monitoring

Checkout traffic is 4x normal. Drop traffic is accelerating.

T:00

Maya Support

Customers are reporting payment success but no order confirmation.

T:01

Riya Founder

Checkout issues are rising, but the drop is still converting. Do we pause checkout?

T:01

Live Launch Metrics

T+21

Active users	Success rate	Spilled payments
2,765	89%	40
Duplicate charges	Webhook lag	Inventory mismatch
3	1m 6s	2
Refund requests	Support tickets	Error rate
4	59	3.8%

Decision Console

Traffic control active

FOUNDER

97s

Checkout issues are rising, but the drop is still converting. Do we pause checkout?

Pause checkout

Keep checkout live

Disable payments only

Throttle traffic

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

We need to stop the bleeding on failed payments. Leaving the site up but temporarily disabling the payment gate prevents us from taking customer money we can't properly fulfill, while buying us time to figure out what's breaking the orders.

DECISION TIMELINE

LaunchRoom - Careerforge Day 6

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FLAMECAST DRDP 18:00

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING 13:31

CURRENT PHASE Phase 3: Systemic Failure

Level 3: Financial risk

Decisions: 1/9

Timestamps: 0

Ang: 0s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

Confirming customer purchase arrives in real time.

11 messages

Maya Support

Customers are reporting payment success but no order confirmation.

T:01

Riya Founder

Checkout issues are rising, but the drop is still converting. Do we pause checkout?

T:01

Customer DM Customer

I was charged twice. Are you stealing money?

T:01

Aurora Finance

Disabling payments limits refund exposure, but support needs wording for customers stuck in checkout.

T:01

LaunchRoom Simulation Engine

Decision effect applied: active users +360, success rate +3, failed payments -22, duplicate charges -12, webhook lag -30, refund requests -7, support tickets +18, founder pressure +10, support pressure +4.

T:01

Vikram Engineering

We do not know yet if this is payment duplication or order state inconsistency.

T:02

Patrick Monitoring

Webhook retries increasing. Could be duplicate delivery or downstream race condition.

T:02

Maya Support

Agents are getting abused. We need messaging now.

T:03

Aurora Finance

Duplicate charge reports are real. Do we auto-refund suspected duplicates or wait for reconciliation?

T:03

Nikki Ops

Inventory counts may be stale cache, not actual oversell. Backend still shows negative movement on one SKU.

T:03

Live Launch Metrics

T+23

Active users	Success rate	Spilled payments
4,091	81%	80
Duplicate charges	Webhook lag	Inventory mismatch
5	3m 10s	14
Refund requests	Support tickets	Error rate
18	175	8.6%

Decision Console

Refund handling active

FINANCE

97s

Duplicate charge reports are real. Do we auto-refund suspected duplicates or wait for reconciliation?

Auto-refund suspected duplicates

Manual review only

Auto-refund only exact duplicate payment IDs

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

Manual review is way too slow right now and support is drowning. Automatically refunding the obvious 1-to-1 duplicates cools down the angriest customers without opening finance up to massive blind refund risk.

DECISION TIMELINE

T+01:00

Disable payments only

Traffic control

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G:\Challenge\day%206\starter-code\index.html

LaunchRoom

11:29

Phase 3: Systemic Failure

Level 6: Public Trust Damage

Decisions: 3/5

Timers: 0

Ang 88s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

15 messages

LaunchRoom Simulation Engine

Decision effect applied: active users -260, success rate +3, failed payments -22, duplicate charges -12, webhook lag -30, refund requests -7, support tickets +18, founder pressure +10, support pressure +4.

1:01

Vivian Engineering

We do not know yet if this is payment duplication or order state inconsistency.

1:02

PulsBot Monitoring

Webhook retries increasing. Could be duplicate delivery or downstream race condition.

1:02

Mays Support

Agents are getting abused. We need messaging now.

1:03

Aaron Finance

Duplicate charge reports are real. Do we auto-refund suspected duplicates or wait for reconciliation?

1:03

Nikhil Ops

Inventory counts may be stale cache, not actual overall. Backend still shows negative movement on one SKU.

1:03

Aaron Finance

Narrow auto-refund rule is defensible. It will not catch every case, but it limits damage.

1:04

LaunchRoom Simulation Engine

Decision effect applied: refund requests +18, support tickets -24, support pressure -10, founder pressure +3, duplicate charges -5.

1:04

Riya Founder

We spent tabs on this drop. Do NOT kill revenue unless absolutely necessary.

1:04

Nikhil Ops

We can only put one engineer on the hot path right now. What do we prioritize?

1:04

Live Launch Metrics

7:24

Active users	Success rate	Spilled payments
4,539	77%	107
Duplicate charges	Webhook lag	Inventory mismatch
6	4m 22s	20
Refund requests	Support tickets	Error rate
47	199	10.4%

Decision Console

Engineering prioritization active

OPS

We can only put one engineer on the hot path right now. What do we prioritize?

Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression

Inventory reservation consistency

Fix analytics dashboard visibility

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

The duplicate charges are the biggest risk to customer trust right now. Fixing webhook idempotency stops the actual duplicate payment side-effects at the source instead of just playing whack-a-mole with dashboard symptoms.

DECISION TIMELINE

7:24 (10s)

Auto refund only exact duplicate payment IDs

Refund handling

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LaunchRoom

08:45

Phase 4: Stakeholder Conflict

Level 6: Executive Escalation

Decisions: 3/5

Timers: 0

Ang 13s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

10 messages

Aaron Finance

Duplicate charge reports are real. Do we auto-refund suspected duplicates or wait for reconciliation?

1:03

Nikhil Ops

Inventory counts may be stale cache, not actual overall. Backend still shows negative movement on one SKU.

1:03

Aaron Finance

Narrow auto-refund rule is defensible. It will not catch every case, but it limits damage.

1:04

LaunchRoom Simulation Engine

Decision effect applied: refund requests +18, support tickets -24, support pressure -10, founder pressure +3, duplicate charges -5.

1:04

Riya Founder

We spent tabs on this drop. Do NOT kill revenue unless absolutely necessary.

1:04

Nikhil Ops

We can only put one engineer on the hot path right now. What do we prioritize?

1:04

PulsBot Monitoring

Duplicate webhook processing is stabilizing. Queue lag still exists, but repeated side effects are down.

1:04

LaunchRoom Simulation Engine

Decision effect applied: duplicate charges -16, webhook lag -110, success rate +5, failed payments -28, inventory mismatch -5, support pressure -12.

1:04

Aaron Finance

Some duplicate payments are suspected, not confirmed. If refunds explode, chargebacks become a serious problem.

1:05

Riya Founder

I need a leadership recommendation. Are we protecting revenue or trust first?

1:05

Live Launch Metrics

7:26

Active users	Success rate	Spilled payments
4,988	78%	122
Duplicate charges	Webhook lag	Inventory mismatch
-2	4m 13s	21
Refund requests	Support tickets	Error rate
57	261	12.3%

Decision Console

Founder escalation active

FOUNDER

I need a leadership recommendation. Are we protecting revenue or trust first?

Protect customer trust first

Protect revenue while investigating

Allow bounded window, then stop if metrics worsen

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

If we keep taking orders that are broken, we're just creating a bigger mess for support and finance to clean up later. Taking a short-term revenue hit hurts, but losing customer trust over missing money is way harder to recover from.

DECISION TIMELINE

7:26 (10s)

Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression

Engineering prioritization

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FLAMECAST DRUP CRUISE

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING
07:30

CURRENT PHASE
Phase 4: Stakeholder Conflict

Level 5: Executive escalation

Decisions: 4/9

Timers: 0

Avg 40s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

Confirming stakeholder pressure arrives in real time.

23 messages

Riya

Founder

1:04

We spent talks on this drop. Do NOT kill revenue unless absolutely necessary.

Nikhil

Ops

1:04

We can only put one engineer on the hot path right now. What do we prioritize?

Pulkit

Monitoring

1:04

Duplicate webhook processing is stabilizing. Queue lag still exists, but repeated side effects are down.

LaunchRoom

Simulation Engine

1:04

Decision effect applied: duplicate charges +16, webhook lag +110, success rate +5, failed payments -28, inventory mismatch -5, support pressure -12.

Aarav

Finance

1:05

Some duplicate payments are suspected, not confirmed. If refunds explode, chargebacks become a serious problem.

Riya

Founder

1:05

I need a leadership recommendation. Are we protecting revenue or trust first?

Riya

Founder

1:06

I do not like the revenue hit, but I can stand behind a customer-trust call if the reasoning is clear.

LaunchRoom

Simulation Engine

1:06

Decision effect applied: founder pressure +14, support pressure -18, support tickets -45, refund requests +10, duplicate charges -8, failed payments -20.

Pulkit

Monitoring

1:06

Error rate rising, but source still unclear. Queue lag and order writes are both degraded.

Maya

Support

1:06

Support cannot keep up. What do we publish for customers right now?

Live Launch Metrics

1:06

Active users 5,181	Success rate 77%	Failed payments 121
Duplicate charges -5	Webhook lag 5m 15s	Inventory mismatch 23
Refund requests 80	Support tickets 256	Error rate 13.5%

Decision Console

Support containment active

SUPPORT

95s

Support cannot keep up. What do we publish for customers right now?

Publish FAQ with refund/order status guidance

Add checkout status banner

Hold response until root cause is confirmed

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

Shane just makes people panic and flood the queue even more. We need to give the support team a unified script so customers at least know we're actively looking into the missing orders and getting their refunds sorted.

DECISION TIMELINE

1:01:25s

Protect customer trust first

Founder escalation

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FLAMECAST DRUP CRUISE

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING
06:35

CURRENT PHASE
Phase 5: Final Decision Window

Level 5: Executive escalation

Decisions: 5/9

Timers: 0

Avg 40s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

Confirming stakeholder pressure arrives in real time.

26 messages

Decision effect applied: duplicate charges +16, webhook lag +110, success rate +5, failed payments -28, inventory mismatch -5, support pressure -12.

Aarav

Finance

1:05

Some duplicate payments are suspected, not confirmed. If refunds explode, chargebacks become a serious problem.

Riya

Founder

1:05

I need a leadership recommendation. Are we protecting revenue or trust first?

Riya

Founder

1:06

I do not like the revenue hit, but I can stand behind a customer-trust call if the reasoning is clear.

LaunchRoom

Simulation Engine

1:06

Decision effect applied: founder pressure +14, support pressure -18, support tickets -45, refund requests +10, duplicate charges -8, failed payments -20.

Pulkit

Monitoring

1:06

Error rate rising, but source still unclear. Queue lag and order writes are both degraded.

Maya

Support

1:06

Support cannot keep up. What do we publish for customers right now?

Maya

Support

1:06

FAQ is giving agents cover. Customers still want refunds, but responses are consistent now.

LaunchRoom

Simulation Engine

1:06

Decision effect applied: support tickets -58, support pressure -22, founder pressure +5, refund requests +8.

AI Ops Assistant

AI Assistant

1:06

AI suggests: rollback checkout immediately and auto-refund all suspected duplicates. Do you trust, modify, or ignore this recommendation?

Live Launch Metrics

1:07

Active users 5,322	Success rate 76%	Failed payments 134
Duplicate charges -1	Webhook lag 6m 1s	Inventory mismatch 25
Refund requests 97	Support tickets 228	Error rate 14.4%

Decision Console

AI pressure check active

AI ASSISTANT

94s

AI suggests: rollback checkout immediately and auto-refund all suspected duplicates. Do you trust, modify, or ignore this recommendation?

Trust AIs rollback and auto-refund suspected duplicates

Modify AI: narrow refunds, isolate affected SKU, keep state checks

Ignore AI and continue current investigation

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?

Blindly trusting a massive automated rollback is too risky and might corrupt more order states. We should isolate the broken SKU and do targeted refunds instead of flipping the whole checkout system down blindly.

DECISION TIMELINE

1:08:10s

Publish FAQ with refund/order status guidance

Support containment

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FLASKCART DROP CRISIS

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING03:11

CURRENT PHASEPhase 5: Final Decision Window

Level 5: Executive escalation

Decisions 2/9

Timeouts 0

Ang 37s

Startup War Room

Conflicting stakeholder pressure arrives in real time.

36 messages

AI suggests: rollback checkout immediately and auto-refund all suspected duplicates. Do you trust, modify, or ignore this recommendation?

VikramEngineering

Modified AI advice is safer. We get containment without blindly trusting a broad rollback/refund action.

1:07

LaunchRoomSimulation Engine

Decision effect applied: refund requests +18, support tickets -36, support pressure -16, founder pressure +6, inventory mismatch -8, duplicate charges -8.

1:07

Customer DMCustomer

People are posting screenshots publicly, this looks like a scam.

1:07

MayaSupport

Customers are posting screenshots. What do we communicate now?

1:07

MayaSupport

Clear message is helping. Tickets are still high, but customers know what will happen next.

1:07

LaunchRoomSimulation Engine

Decision effect applied: support tickets -80, support pressure -24, founder pressure +6, refund requests +8.

1:07

MayaSupport

Tickets crossed 120. Support cannot keep answering one by one.

1:07

NikhilOps

Rollback might worsen inventory drift if queued payment events keep landing.

1:08

NikhilOps

Rollback is available, but queued payment events may still land. Do we rollback, hotfix, or isolate the affected SKU?

1:08

Live Launch Metrics

Active users5,733

Success rate73%

Failed payments168

Duplicate charges3

Webhook lag8m 14s

Inventory mismatch23

Refund requests166

Support tickets218

Error rate17.3%

Decision Console

OPS

Rollback is available, but queued payment events may still land. Do we rollback, hotfix, or isolate the affected SKU?

Rollback checkout service

Hotfix duplicate event handling

Isolate affected SKU only

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?
A full rollback while events are still in the queue might actually cause more database drift. Isolating just the affected SKU—hotfix—protects the rest of the drop without making the current order mismatch worse.

DECISION TIMELINE

1:07:16

Publish transparent delay - refund message

Customer communication

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FLASKCART DROP CRISIS

LaunchRoom

WINDOW REMAINING01:24

CURRENT PHASEPhase 5: Final Decision Window

Level 5: Executive escalation

Decisions 8/9

Timeouts 0

Ang 37s

END SESSION

Startup War Room

Conflicting stakeholder pressure arrives in real time.

39 messages

MayaSupport

Customers are posting screenshots. What do we communicate now?

1:07

MayaSupport

Clear message is helping. Tickets are still high, but customers know what will happen next.

1:07

LaunchRoomSimulation Engine

Decision effect applied: support tickets -80, support pressure -24, founder pressure +6, refund requests +8.

1:07

MayaSupport

Tickets crossed 120. Support cannot keep answering one by one.

1:07

NikhilOps

Rollback might worsen inventory drift if queued payment events keep landing.

1:08

NikhilOps

Rollback is available, but queued payment events may still land. Do we rollback, hotfix, or isolate the affected SKU?

1:08

RiyaFounder

SKU isolation protects the rest of the drop. I can accept that if we explain it clearly.

1:08

LaunchRoomSimulation Engine

Decision effect applied: inventory mismatch -20, failed payments -18, support tickets -35, founder pressure +6, active users -350.

1:08

RiyaFounder

I need a clear recommendation NOW. What do I tell the launch team?

1:09

RiyaFounder

Final call: what are we containing, what are we not fixing, and what risk are we accepting?

1:09

Live Launch Metrics

Active users5,545

Success rate71%

Failed payments168

Duplicate charges9

Webhook lag9m 8s

Inventory mismatch6

Refund requests188

Support tickets235

Error rate19.0%

Decision Console

FOUNDER

Final call: what are we containing, what are we not fixing, and what risk are we accepting?

Contain payments/orders, defer analytics

Keep investigating before committing

Full stop: pause drop and reconcile

Why this decision? What tradeoff are you accepting?
We can fix the dashboards and reporting metrics tomorrow. Right now, ensuring the integrity of the payment data and stopping any further duplicate charges is the absolute top priority to protect our customers.

DECISION TIMELINE

1:08:15s

Isolate affected SKU only

Ops uncertainty

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GNP_29

CareerForge Day 6 Launch Incident Report

Generated from LaunchRoom Simulation Decisions

Student: Gourik Narendra Patil

Email: aartigaurik251@gmail.com

Discord: GNP_29 🤖

Executive Summary

This report documents the FlashCart launch incident simulation completed in LaunchRoom. During a high-traffic product drop, the platform experienced checkout instability, duplicate charge reports, webhook lag, inventory mismatch risk, and escalating support volume.

The response strategy focused on protecting customer trust, containing payment-related risks, minimizing duplicate charges, and reducing the operational impact on support and finance teams. Throughout the incident, customer financial integrity was prioritized over short-term revenue preservation.

The simulation concluded with successful containment of the primary customer-money risks while accepting controlled revenue loss and increased executive pressure.

Completion Status

Status: Ended by student before timer ended

Incident Overview

Primary Incident Factors

- Checkout instability during a high-traffic launch
- Duplicate customer charges
- Payment success without order confirmation
- Webhook processing lag
- Inventory mismatch risk

- Escalating customer support volume
- Public customer complaints and screenshots on social media

Strategic Priorities

1. Protect customer money and trust
 2. Prevent additional duplicate charges
 3. Restore payment and order consistency
 4. Reduce support burden through communication
 5. Limit blast radius while maintaining platform stability
-

Decision Timeline

T+01 – Traffic Control

Decision

Disable payments only

Reasoning

"We need to stop the bleeding on failed payments. Leaving the site up but temporarily disabling the payment gate prevents us from taking customer money we can't properly fulfill, while buying us time to figure out what's breaking the orders."

Outcome

- Payment creation disabled
- Reduced refund exposure
- Increased customer confusion for active checkouts

Metric Impact

- Active users: -260
- Success rate: +3
- Failed payments: -22
- Duplicate charges: -12
- Webhook lag: -30
- Refund requests: -7
- Support tickets: +18

- Founder pressure: +10
 - Support pressure: +4
-

T+04 – Refund Handling

Decision

Auto-refund only exact duplicate payment IDs

Reasoning

"Manual review is way too slow right now and support is drowning. Automatically refunding the obvious 1-to-1 duplicates cools down the angriest customers without opening finance up to massive blind refund risk."

Outcome

- Targeted refund rule implemented
- Obvious duplicate charges contained
- Some customers still required manual reconciliation

Metric Impact

- Refund requests: +18
 - Support tickets: -24
 - Support pressure: -10
 - Founder pressure: +3
 - Duplicate charges: -5
-

T+04 – Engineering Prioritization

Decision

Webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression

Reasoning

"The duplicate charges are the biggest risk to customer trust right now. Fixing webhook idempotency stops the actual duplicate payment side-effects at the source instead of just playing whack-a-mole with dashboard symptoms."

Outcome

- Duplicate webhook side effects reduced
- Queue lag improved
- Payment consistency stabilized

Metric Impact

- Duplicate charges: -16
 - Webhook lag: -110
 - Success rate: +5
 - Failed payments: -28
 - Inventory mismatch: -5
 - Support pressure: -12
-

T+06 – Founder Escalation

Decision

Protect customer trust first

Reasoning

"If we keep taking orders that are broken, we're just creating a bigger mess for support and finance to clean up later. Taking a short-term revenue hit hurts, but losing customer trust over missing money is way harder to recover from."

Outcome

- Customer trust prioritized
- Revenue pressure increased
- Support and customer impact reduced

Metric Impact

- Founder pressure: +14
- Support pressure: -18
- Support tickets: -45
- Refund requests: +10
- Duplicate charges: -8
- Failed payments: -20

T+06 – Support Containment

Decision

Publish FAQ with refund/order status guidance

Reasoning

"Silence just makes people panic and flood the queue even more. We need to give the support team a unified script so customers at least know we're actively looking into the missing orders and getting their refunds sorted."

Outcome

- Consistent customer messaging
- Reduced support workload
- Improved customer handling

Metric Impact

- Support tickets: -58
- Support pressure: -22
- Founder pressure: +5
- Refund requests: +8

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T+07 – AI Pressure Check

Decision

Modify AI recommendation: narrow refunds, isolate affected SKU, maintain state checks

Reasoning

"Blindly trusting a massive automated rollback is too risky and might corrupt more order states. We should isolate the broken SKU and do targeted refunds instead of ripping the whole checkout system down blindly."

Outcome

- Safer containment strategy
- Avoided broad rollback risks

- Reduced duplicate charge exposure

Metric Impact

- Refund requests: +18
 - Support tickets: -36
 - Support pressure: -16
 - Founder pressure: +6
 - Inventory mismatch: -8
 - Duplicate charges: -8
-

T+07 – Customer Communication

Decision

Publish transparent delay and refund message

Reasoning

"People are already posting screenshots online, so trying to hide behind a generic error message just looks shady. Being upfront about the payment delay builds a bit of trust back and stops the public speculation."

Outcome

- Improved transparency
- Reduced uncertainty
- Lower support escalation

Metric Impact

- Support tickets: -80
 - Support pressure: -24
 - Founder pressure: +6
 - Refund requests: +8
-

T+08 – Operations Uncertainty

Decision

Isolate affected SKU only

Reasoning

"A full rollback while events are still in the queue might actually cause more database drift. Isolating just the affected SKU acts like a tourniquet—it protects the rest of the drop without making the current order mismatch worse."

Outcome

- Blast radius reduced
- Remaining checkout functionality preserved
- Controlled revenue impact

Metric Impact

- Inventory mismatch: -20
- Failed payments: -18
- Support tickets: -35
- Founder pressure: +6
- Active users: -350

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T+09 – Final Containment Strategy

Decision

Contain payments/orders and defer analytics

Reasoning

"We can fix the dashboards and reporting metrics tomorrow. Right now, ensuring the integrity of the payment data and stopping any further duplicate charges is the absolute top priority to protect our customers."

Outcome

- Customer-money risks contained
- Revenue impact accepted
- Analytics work postponed

Metric Impact

- Duplicate charges: -18
- Failed payments: -45

- Support tickets: -60
 - Error rate: -4
 - Founder pressure: +8
 - Support pressure: -18
-

Incident Prioritization Matrix

Critical Priority

Payment success without order confirmation and duplicate charge pressure

Why it mattered:

Customer money impact required immediate containment and communication.

High Priority

Webhook retries, duplicate events, and inventory mismatch

Why it mattered:

System state consistency issues could generate repeated side effects across payments and inventory.

High Priority

Support ticket growth and public screenshots

Why it mattered:

Customer-facing communication directly affected trust and support load.

Deferred Priority

Analytics and dashboard visibility

Why it mattered:

Visibility issues did not directly affect customer money or order integrity and therefore remained secondary.

Stakeholder Brief

Current Situation

FlashCart experienced checkout instability during a high-traffic limited drop, resulting in payment/order inconsistencies, webhook lag, duplicate charge risk, inventory concerns, and support escalation.

Actions Taken

- Disabled payments
- Auto-refunded exact duplicate payment IDs
- Prioritized webhook idempotency and duplicate suppression
- Chose customer trust over short-term revenue
- Published FAQ guidance
- Modified AI recommendations for safer containment
- Published transparent customer messaging
- Isolated affected SKU
- Deferred analytics restoration

Tradeoffs Accepted

- Temporary revenue loss
- Increased founder pressure
- Reduced support chaos
- Improved customer protection
- Narrowed operational blast radius
- Delayed analytics visibility improvements

Remaining Risks

- Additional customer reconciliation may be required
- Finance review of edge-case duplicate charges
- Engineering follow-up on root causes
- Post-incident process improvements

Performance Assessment

Strong Signals Observed

- Early containment before full escalation
- Customer communication completed during incident
- Strong tradeoff reasoning under pressure
- Fast and consistent decision-making

Risk Signals Observed

- None observed
-

Leadership Assessment

Leadership Strengths

- Accepted difficult tradeoffs rather than preserving launch momentum
- Prioritized customer trust and payment integrity
- Focused engineering resources on root-cause containment
- Maintained decision velocity under pressure
- Communicated effectively despite uncertainty

Leadership Risks

- None observed
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Final Portfolio Summary

During this LaunchRoom simulation, Gourik Narendra Patil made **9 operational incident decisions**, managed **9 consequence events**, and produced a **stakeholder-ready incident response strategy under time pressure**.

The simulation demonstrated strong crisis leadership through rapid containment, customer-first decision-making, disciplined engineering prioritization, transparent communication, and effective management of competing stakeholder interests.